



Christmas Budget & Gift Planner

Every gift, every dollar, every deadline,
all in one place. No January regrets.

by Holly Bramble · @hollybrambledaysathome

"It doesn't have to be perfect. It has to be ours."

This planner belongs to: _____

How to use this planner

Ten minutes now saves you a lot of stress in December.

1. **Set your total budget** on the next page, and don't touch it after that.
2. **List everyone** you're buying for on the Gift List pages, with a budget beside each name.
3. **Brainstorm ideas** before you shop. Shopping without a list is where budgets break.
4. **Track every purchase** on the Spending Tracker as you go. Keep the receipts.
5. **Check the deadlines page** for shipping and wrapping dates, so nothing arrives on the 26th.
6. **Plan the extras:** stockings, cards, hosting and food. These are the costs that sneak up on you.

Holly's rule: spend about **75%** of your budget on gifts and keep **25%** for the sneaky extras: wrapping, shipping, stocking stuffers, teacher gifts, the office swap and the extra roll of tape on the 23rd.

Tip: print the Gift List and Spending Tracker pages twice if you have a big family. You'll fill them faster than you think.

My Christmas Budget

Decide it once. Write it down. Stick to it.

Category	Budget	Spent	Left
 Gifts			
 Stocking stuffers			
 Wrapping, tags & bows			
 Cards & postage			
 Shipping			
 Food & baking			
 Hosting & parties			
 Decorations			
 Teacher, coworker & swap gifts			
 Charity & giving			
 Other			
TOTAL			

Where the money comes from

Savings goal per week until Dec 20

Gift List

Who's on the list, what they're getting, and whether it's done.

Name	Gift idea	Budget	Spent	Bought	Wrapped	Given

Gift List (continued)

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Gift Idea Brainstorm

Jot down hints all year. Write ideas here before you shop.

Name: _____

Name: _____

Name: _____

Name: _____

Name: _____

Name: _____

Name: _____

Name: _____

Spending Tracker

Write down every purchase, including the small ones.

[illegible]

Spending Tracker (continued)

Write down every purchase, including the small ones.

[illegible]

Stocking Stuffers

Small things add up fast. Give each stocking a budget.

Stocking for: _____ Budget: \$_____

Stocking for: _____ Budget: \$_____

Stocking for: _____ Budget: \$_____

Stocking for: _____ Budget: \$_____

Stocking for: _____ Budget: \$_____

Stocking for: _____ Budget: \$_____

Online Orders & Deliveries

Know what's coming and when.

[illegible]

Key Dates & Deadlines

Shipping cutoffs change every year. Check your carriers' websites and write this year's dates here.

Deadline	Date	Done
Final day to order online (standard shipping)		☐
USPS ground / retail cutoff		☐
USPS priority mail cutoff		☐
UPS / FedEx ground cutoff		☐
Mail holiday cards by		☐
Ship gifts to out-of-town family by		☐
Black Friday		☐
Cyber Monday		☐
Office / school party		☐
Gift swap		☐
All wrapping finished by		☐
		☐

November 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30					

December 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
		1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24 Christmas Eve	25 Christmas	26
27	28	29	30	31 New Year's Eve		

Holiday Card List

Addresses once, so next year is easy.

Name	Address	Sent ✓	Received ✓

Christmas Menu & Hosting

Christmas Eve menu

Christmas Day menu

Grocery list

Make-ahead plan

After-Christmas Review

Five minutes on December 26th makes next year easier.

Question	My answer
Total I actually spent	
Over or under budget? By how much?	
Best gift I gave	
What I'll start earlier next year	
What I'll skip next year	
Post-Christmas sales to buy for next year	

Next year's savings goal: divide this year's total by 52. Saving that much each week means next December is already paid for.

\$_____ ÷ 52 = \$_____ per week

Merry Christmas from my kitchen to yours. 🌲
— Holly